

CAROLINEBLIXTEDITFINAL1

Travel Radio Australia, and I'm very honoured to be interviewing a golf professional who travels the world, Caroline Blixst. Now, she is the founder of Blixst Media and Unpar. She's a luxury golf travel entrepreneur, content storyteller, and a high-end event host.

Caroline, welcome to the program. Thank you very much, and I love the intro. You really captured everything I do in like one well sentence.

Not many people can do that. Yes, well, there's a lot that you cover. It's incredible.

I've been looking at your about section on LinkedIn, and the amount of things you do in the world of golf and beyond is just incredible. Caroline, you're based in Stockholm in Sweden, and you travel all around Europe and around the world indeed. Can you give us a bit of a background about yourself? How did you first get involved in golf, I suppose, as a young girl in Uppsala in Sweden? I suppose you picked up a set of golf clubs at some point and discovered a whole new world.

I think that is what everyone thinks is the story, but it's very far from the truth. I usually say I'm like the happy Gilmore of golf, like as a girl, because I actually grew up playing many other sports. First of all, I'm a big sports person.

I love sports, especially doing them myself, but also not working in them and watching them and everything. I'm a sports nut, but I actually grew up playing indoor hockey. That was my main sport, so I did that on a very high level, probably like basketball, gymnastics, soccer, you know, everything, skiing, snowboarding.

But I actually hated golf. I thought it was, you know, yeah, I thought it was way too boring. It took way too much time, everyone else.

So I basically just played when my dad forced me to play. My family, though, is a golf family, especially my dad and obviously my brother. He started playing golf young, seven or eight or something.

You know, he plays very, very well. What happened was that I got injured. I broke this in my back.

So I was in hospital and I couldn't move, and that kind of destroyed my hockey career. But I was dating a golfer and my family to bring me back to both sports, but also socially, because I was kind of locked inside the house for months. So that golf kind of brought me back into movement, sports and socializing again.

So after that, that's when I really started, and I was 20 plus, 22, 23 or something at that point. Yes, yes. That's quite late, isn't it, for you to get into the golf world, because many, many

professional golf people start extremely early.

I know. Well, I only played on a high level of golf short, I think also because I started so late. So, you know, when I started, but I will say I'm very determined when I do something.

When I started, I played and practiced a lot. I was so determined to be good. And then I was also part time living, spending a lot of time in the U.S. So I was surrounded by the best golf pros in the world at TPC Sawgrass.

So, you know, I got a lot of extra help from the best place in the world. And I also think that if you surround yourself with people that are better than you, you will grow exponentially faster than, you know, if you surround yourself with people that are at your same level or not as good as you are. So I think that also helped me develop really, really fast.

So, yeah, about their story. Yeah. Incredible story.

And you started your own company, really, that does high level golf experiences. And you're an international speaker now on the international golf circuit. And I ran into you at the ILGM, the International Luxury Golf, ILGM rather, sorry, the International Luxury GM in Cannes in France.

And I suppose you get to travel the world doing what you do. Tell us a bit about that. Yeah, I always also had a mindset that I wanted to do something like in business.

Two things that I was passionate about and that I love. And I love sports and I love travel. Travel is like my second passion in life.

I absolutely love to visit new places and meet new people and cultures and nature, everything. And then combine that with sport, I think, you know, is the best thing in life to be honest with you. I kind of developed my life and my companies around those things.

Yeah. So like both my media company and now Unpar, the exclusive golf travel agency is all around sports and travel. I do other sports now than only golf.

Golf is my main sport, but I do have clients for tennis or F1 or even hiking, different things as well, which I enjoy because it gives me other perspectives. I love other sports. I love tennis, by the way.

I play a lot of tennis now. So it's actually pretty fun to branch out a little bit. And we are looking forward to you visiting us in Australia at some point, because I know it's been a bit of a dream of yours and especially having lived for eight years in Sweden as a Aussie slash English person.

Yeah. People in Sweden who say to me that it is their absolute dream to visit Australia. And we get huge amounts of backpackers and people here in their early twenties who come here for a year and work all around Australia.

And we'd love to see you here in Australia too. I suppose it's something you've been thinking about for a while. Oh my God.

It is a absolute dream for me. I was in Australia many years ago now. I was actually carrying my brother for a few of his first pro tournaments.

For those who don't know, my brother is a PJ tour player and has been for 20 years. I don't care anymore, obviously. But some of his first tournaments I was carrying and he did really well, I will say.

But it was in Australia, New Zealand, and I absolutely loved it, but I didn't have the opportunity to play myself. But I loved the country and the golf courses and the mix of nature, business, the hospitality. I think that's also what draws a lot of Swedish people, because I used to say that it feels like it's a mix.

You tell me. I feel like it's the best mix of Swedish, European and American. That's the Australian.

That's nicer, but... I look at Australians, Canadians and Swedish as sort of having the same mindset. We look at the world in the same sort of way. I agree.

Yeah, we're all pretty relaxed and pretty easygoing kind of people and together. I find those three kind of nationalities seem together really well. The thing is, Australia these days is so beautiful and so diverse and so welcoming to people from all around the world.

I found that also about Sweden. I found that being an Australian really opened a huge amount of doors for me in Sweden. I might not have got that if I was maybe European or British, even though I was born in London.

Being an Australian since I was quite young, I found that big for my contacts and everything in Sweden. I really appreciated that. Yeah, I think, you know, everywhere, you know, when I go somewhere, I'm very exotic because I'm Swedish.

And Sweden is such a small country. When we get people from Australia, I mean, France, like the US, whatever, they are very exotic for us in our country. And I think that curiosity is in everyone, wherever you go in the world.

I know, on par, what I do now is we focus on very exclusive, customized trips because it's kind of like how I like to develop travel as well. I mean, the exclusive part is fun, but also the fun part for me is to develop something very special, very unique for a person that makes that person experience something that they have dreamt about or always wanted to do exactly for them. So that's kind of what I want to do.

But in general, also, I think that travel and sports, both of them on a higher level, makes people come together. You know, it makes people meet each other in a new way. It makes people more

in the world we live in now with all the war and everything.

It makes it creates like this platform where people unite independent on country, culture and color, which I think I want to embrace even more and also why I want to travel the world and show people we are all the same in one way. We should all come together and not do what we do in the world so much right now. And that's why I like also like the kind of the message I want to be when I speak and everything.

So united in one way, but it has different aspects of what I do. Yes. And tell us about in detail one of the trips you've done recently with people that have stood out for you.

I've done I mean, I've done so many fun things. But one that stood out recently, I did one, which I think also surprised me a little bit. So I have one really good client.

One of his dreams was to play in a pro-am on like a professional tour. So I got him into playing pro-am in Paris at one of the DP World Tour events, which is, you know, if you're not a partner or you're it's kind of impossible. So I had to work on that a lot.

But then we also spend a few days playing some of the private courses around Paris. And I think that for me, it was such an eye opener. You know, Paris is such a well, I mean, globally known city and brand for everything.

But nobody really knows the hidden treasures they have when it comes to golf courses all around the city. And it was so much fun bringing that to them, but also for myself, honestly, to experience that the combination of the glory and the light and the glamour and everything with Paris and then discover these amazing golf courses. So that was a really, really fun trip to do.

The amount of things that you'd see in a year on the road for at least half the year, I suppose, out of Sweden. And can you just give us some of your favourite destinations that you really, that stand out for you? Yeah, I get that question a lot. And sometimes it's like picking your babies, right? Who do you like the most? Yeah, because generally I think, you know, I mean, not each, but yes, like almost each place I go has its own special thing.

And when people come to me, I usually, you know, it's, you have to also look into yourself and think, what do I want to get out of this trip? Because then it's much more easier for me to work with it. But it's very different to go to a city than to go to a beach or an island or go to a desert, right? But they all are very unique in their special ways, to answer your question, because not to be too vague. One of my favourite things, or actually one of my first golf trips I did, I stood out, I went to Jamaica.

It was so cool. They had white lady, white teeth or something was the course. Like there was two really, really nice golf courses.

And then, you know, it was my first time kind of playing in a tropical environment like that on an

island. Mangoes from the trees, and we played on the sandy beaches, and we stayed in luxury huts on the beach, and it was so magical. So that was very, very, very cool.

When I went to Mauritius the first time, I still love that island because the things you can do in a small area in Mauritius is, it's mind-blowing. You can play some of the best golf courses I've ever played. One of my favourites is La Reserve, which also now has DP Tour events and Legends Tour events and stuff.

So it's one of most unique links courses in the world. But you can also hike volcanoes, swim with dolphins, watch whales, go on the sandy white beaches, go to jungle in one day. Like it's so close to each other.

And I love that about it. So you can get so much value of your trip. I think I was like the last one, I think when I went to New Zealand, I did this crazy thing.

So first, after I carried my brother, I met a guy on the tour. Well, he wasn't playing, but and then he had a plane. So we flew all over the South Island, and then we stayed at this sheep farm, which was such an amazing experience.

And then the last day, because I'm crazy, people say. I was like, I can't. No, you have to be a little crazy, I found.

Well, it's more fun when you're a little crazy. So I ended my trip with doing the highest bungee jump you can do in the morning. And then I did a skydive in the afternoon on one day.

But yeah, it was, let's say I would not recommend it, to be honest with you, because I have never felt so bad in my life that night. No, I think like all my adrenaline was just gone and pumped up. And I just, I could not, I think at six o'clock I was in bed and I was trying not to puke basically.

But do you know the weird thing too is that when I did my skydive, because I did the bungee jump first, I did not even feel any adrenaline when I did the skydiving. Can you imagine? It was like my body was dead. Took it all out of you.

The adrenaline was drained out. Yeah. So I need to do it again.

Yeah, that's great. Now, Caroline Blix, she's a fantastic luxury golf travel entrepreneur. She's a tour guide.

She takes people on high-end trips all over the world. And tell us a bit more about your company Unpar. That's U-N-P-A-R.

Yes, that's right. That's how it is. Tell us about that and Blix Media.

To put it in a short concrete way. So Blix Media was developed first. It was through my, actually

through my social media channels.

It started with me being creative because I have a very creative mind. And then, like I said, also getting everything I loved into my creativity. So I started with golf and traveled there on a very small scale, just for fun.

And that kind of grew. And then, you know, I was starting to travel for work as well. And I, you know, I started to develop my channels.

So in the beginning, it was just, you know, curiosity and fun. And then today I do a lot of content from social media to videos, to hosting, to interviewing everything all over the world. And for brands and golf courses and destinations and stuff.

Unpar and the TripJ company kind of grew out of the media company because I started to get a lot of questions and requests because obviously they saw where I was and what I did. So then I started to take on some private clients myself. And now just a few months ago, actually like six months ago, I joined Venture with a small boutique luxury experiential company here in Stockholm, which also works globally.

So now we are a small little team, but we work with destinations and some of the best brands and companies and clients globally. Now it's two different parts. It was been wonderful talking to you, Caroline, on the program and it's Caroline Blixt.

It's fantastic connecting with you there in Stockholm and I'm on the Gold Coast. So it's a cross the world thing here. So yeah, if you want to connect with me, either you can go on carolineblixt.com or my boutique travel agency is unpar.se. If you want to follow me, I would love to then use the Blixt Caroline on Instagram and also on TikTok.

And also LinkedIn, you know, if you reach out to me on LinkedIn, you're more than welcome. It's my name as well. Yes, B-L-I-X-T, it's Caroline Blixt and it's been fabulous having you on the program on Travel Radio Australia.

Good luck with all your future trips and all your future clients. I'm sure we'll be very happy with you and we so look forward to seeing you in Australia once again, Caroline. It was my pleasure and I really hope to see you in Australia soon.